

“PATENTS Are The BY-PRODUCTS Of The IMPROVEMENTS You Strive To Make”

IIT Madras. MIT. 100 patents. 3 keywords that provide a hint of Dr Manish Kothari's professional journey. Possessing more than 20 years of technology management experience, Dr Kothari has recently taken up the challenge to head Silicon Labs' wireless development centre in India. Electronics For You connected with him to find out his plans to take on the leadership role, how he maintains a work-life balance, and his vision for Silicon Labs India team

You have an impressive hundred patents to your name. What's the secret of success behind that?

As I look back, I think it was really just a desire to always keep learning and make things better. I'm always looking for continuous improvement and the lessons learnt while doing that, and that is the mantra I follow. In every project I'm involved in, I look at what went well, what didn't go well, and this has given me an opportunity to understand how things can be better. Also, I have always been keen on the end-use cases and understanding how differently a particular technology can be used. I read consumer blogs of my products to find out what people are writing about them and read Amazon reviews to find out what the consumer likes or dislikes in a product, and that always gives me an opportunity to keep learning and improving.

I believe that having the mindset of wanting to keep learning just gives you that needed impetus. In terms of innovation, I think everybody can innovate. But of course, sometimes you tend to be lucky and be at the right place when the right innovation is being discovered. While these factors do exist, we all have to be humble enough to recognise this. We must also acknowledge when there is an innovation that could have done better, especially when you realise that the customer is not happy, or the usage for which you built your product is different from how the customer is using it. Innovation is all about doing things for the first time, so if you can come up with an improvement for the first time, that can



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